

NovaPay

Customer Support Knowledge Base | Version 3.3 (Extended) | Effective January 2026

This document is a fictional customer support knowledge base created for demonstration and testing purposes (RAG assignment). NovaPay is not a real company. All figures, fees, and policies below are invented and internally consistent, intended to serve as a controlled corpus for retrieval-augmented question answering.

1. About NovaPay

NovaPay is a digital-first financial technology platform offering a mobile wallet, a prepaid/debit card, peer-to-peer money transfers, and short-term micro-credit through its mobile app and web dashboard. NovaPay partners with a licensed banking institution to hold customer funds and issue payment cards; NovaPay itself operates as the technology and customer-facing service provider. All balances are held in USD unless otherwise noted.

This knowledge base is intended for use by the NovaPay customer support team and support chatbot to answer user questions accurately. If a question falls outside the scope of this document, support agents (and the chatbot) should say so rather than guess.

2. Account Opening & KYC (Know Your Customer)

2.1 Verification Tiers

NovaPay uses a three-tier KYC system. Higher tiers unlock higher limits and more features.

Tier	Verification required	Monthly load limit	Features unlocked
Tier 1 (Basic)	Email + phone number	\$500	Wallet balance, view-only
Tier 2 (Standard)	Government ID + selfie match	\$5,000	Debit card, P2P transfers, ATM withdrawals
Tier 3 (Full)	Proof of address + income declaration	\$25,000	Credit line, international transfers, higher ATM limits

2.2 Verification Time & Rejections

- Tier 1 verification is instant upon signup.
- Tier 2 verification typically completes within 15 minutes and almost always within 24 hours.
- Tier 3 verification can take up to 3 business days due to manual document review.
- If KYC is rejected (blurry document, name mismatch, or expired ID), the user may reapply immediately with corrected documents. There is no cooldown period for a first reapplication, but repeated rejections (3 or more) trigger a mandatory 7-day cooldown before the next attempt.

3. Login, Security & Account Access

- Passwords must be at least 10 characters with one number and one symbol.

- Two-factor authentication (2FA) is mandatory for Tier 2 and Tier 3 accounts, via SMS OTP or an authenticator app (TOTP).
- The mobile app supports biometric login (fingerprint or face ID) once 2FA has been set up at least once.
- Forgotten passwords can be reset via Settings > Forgot Password, which sends a reset link to the registered email, valid for 30 minutes.
- After 5 consecutive failed login attempts, the account is locked for 30 minutes. Users can also contact support to unlock immediately after verifying identity.
- Users can view and deregister previously logged-in devices under Settings > Security > Manage Devices.

4. Adding Money (Deposits)

NovaPay supports three ways to add money to your wallet balance:

Method	Speed	Fee	Limits
Bank transfer (ACH)	1-2 business days	Free	Up to tier monthly limit
Debit/credit card load	Instant	1.5% of amount	Max \$2,000 per load (Tier 2), \$10,000 (Tier 3)
Cash deposit (partner retail locations)	Instant	\$1.50 flat fee	Max \$500 per transaction

The minimum single load amount across all methods is \$5.

5. Sending & Receiving Money

5.1 Peer-to-Peer (P2P) Transfers

- Transfers between NovaPay users are instant and free, with no minimum or per-transaction fee.
- Available to Tier 2 and Tier 3 accounts only.
- Users can also send a 'money request' asking another user to pay them a specific amount; requests expire after 7 days if not paid.

5.2 Bank Transfers (Out)

- Standard transfer to an external bank account: 1-2 business days, free.
- Instant transfer to an external bank account (debit card push): arrives within 30 minutes, fee is 1% of the amount (minimum \$0.50, maximum \$5).

5.3 International Transfers

- Available to Tier 3 accounts only, to over 40 supported countries.
- Delivery time is 1-3 business days depending on destination.
- Fee is a flat \$4.99 plus a 0.5% foreign exchange markup on the converted amount.
- Maximum single international transfer is \$10,000; subject to the account's monthly limit.

6. NovaPay Card (Virtual & Physical Debit Card)

- A virtual card is issued instantly and free of charge once an account reaches Tier 2 KYC. It can be used immediately for online purchases.
- A physical card can be requested from the app and ships within 5-10 business days. There is a one-time \$2.99 shipping fee for Tier 2 accounts; the fee is waived for Tier 3 accounts.
- Cards must be activated in the app after arrival by entering the last 4 digits and a shipping confirmation code.
- If a card is lost or stolen, it should be frozen immediately from the app under Card > Freeze Card, which takes effect instantly. Users should then contact support to request a replacement.
- Replacement card fee is \$5, waived for the first replacement in any 12-month period.
- ATM withdrawals: the first 4 withdrawals each calendar month are free; each withdrawal after that costs \$2.50. The ATM operator may also charge its own separate fee, which NovaPay does not control or refund.
- International card usage is enabled by default on all cards and carries a 2% foreign transaction fee.

7. Fees & Charges Summary

Service	Fee
Account opening	Free
Monthly account maintenance	Free
ACH bank deposit	Free
Instant card load	1.5% of amount
Cash deposit (retail location)	\$1.50 flat
Domestic standard transfer out	Free
Domestic instant transfer out	1% (min \$0.50, max \$5)
International transfer	\$4.99 + 0.5% FX markup
P2P transfer (NovaPay to NovaPay)	Free
ATM withdrawal (after 4 free per month)	\$2.50 per withdrawal
Physical card shipping (Tier 2)	\$2.99 one-time
Physical card shipping (Tier 3)	Free
Card replacement (after first free one/year)	\$5
International card transaction	2% of amount
Dormant account fee (after 12 months inactivity)	\$2 per month
Filing a dispute or chargeback	Free
Credit line: Pay in 30 (repaid within 30 days)	0% interest
Credit line: installment plan (3 or 6 months)	18% APR
Credit line: late payment	\$10 flat fee

8. Failed, Pending & Delayed Transactions

Common reasons a transaction fails or stays pending:

- Insufficient wallet balance.
- Daily or monthly transfer limit exceeded for the account's KYC tier.
- The recipient's bank rejected the transfer (invalid account details).
- A temporary network timeout between NovaPay and the banking partner.
- An attempted action not permitted at the account's current KYC tier (for example, an international transfer attempted from a Tier 2 account).

If a transaction fails after money has already left the wallet balance, it is automatically reversed within 24-48 hours. If the reversal has not happened within 5 business days, the user should contact support directly.

Pending domestic transactions typically resolve within 24 hours; pending international transactions can take up to 5 business days before being marked complete or failed.

9. Refunds, Disputes & Chargebacks

- Merchant refunds for card purchases typically reflect in the NovaPay wallet within 5-7 business days after the merchant processes the refund on their end.
- An unrecognized or unauthorized card transaction must be disputed within 60 days of the transaction date.
- To file a dispute: go to the transaction in the app, tap 'Dispute this transaction', and submit supporting details. A provisional credit is issued within 10 business days while NovaPay investigates.
- Final resolution of a card dispute is provided within 45 days of filing.
- Important: a completed P2P transfer between NovaPay users cannot be reversed by NovaPay once sent, even if sent to the wrong person. Support can attempt to contact the recipient on the sender's behalf and request a voluntary return, but this is not guaranteed and NovaPay cannot compel repayment.

10. NovaPay Credit Line

- Eligibility requires Tier 3 KYC, a minimum of 3 months of account history, and at least \$300 in average monthly inflow.
- Approved credit limits range from \$100 to \$2,000, determined by NovaPay's internal risk scoring model.
- 'Pay in 30': repay the full amount within 30 days at 0% interest.
- Installment plans: extend repayment over 3 or 6 months at 18% APR.
- A missed payment incurs a flat \$10 late fee. Accounts more than 60 days overdue may be reported to a credit bureau.
- There is no prepayment penalty for paying off a credit line balance early.

11. Rewards, Cashback & Referrals

- Card purchases earn 1% cashback in eligible categories (groceries and public transit). Cash withdrawals, P2P transfers, and bill payments do not earn cashback.
- Referral program: the referring user earns \$10 and the new user earns \$5 once the new user completes at least \$50 in total transactions within 30 days of signup.
- Cashback and referral rewards expire 12 months after being earned if not redeemed.

12. Account Limits by Tier (Summary)

Limit type	Tier 1	Tier 2	Tier 3
Monthly load limit	\$500	\$5,000	\$25,000
P2P transfers	Not available	Yes	Yes
ATM withdrawals (free/month)	Not available	4	4
International transfers	Not available	Not available	Yes, up to \$10,000/transfer
Credit line eligibility	Not eligible	Not eligible	Eligible (subject to review)

13. Savings Pockets & Goals

- Users can create up to 5 named Savings Pockets within their wallet to set aside money toward specific goals.
- Savings Pockets earn 2.5% APY on balances up to \$10,000 per pocket; any amount above \$10,000 in a single pocket earns 0.5% APY.
- Interest is calculated daily and paid out once a month on the 1st.
- Auto-save rules are available: round-up on card purchases (rounds each purchase up to the nearest dollar and moves the difference into a chosen pocket), or a scheduled recurring transfer (daily, weekly, or monthly) of a fixed amount.
- Moving money from a Savings Pocket back to the main wallet balance is instant and has no limit or fee.

14. Bill Pay & Recurring Payments

- Users can schedule one-time or recurring payments to registered billers (utilities, rent, subscriptions) under Payments > Bill Pay.
- Recurring payments can be set to run daily, weekly, or monthly on a chosen date.
- Paying a previously saved payee is free. A one-time payment to a brand-new, unsaved payee incurs a \$0.50 fee.
- If a scheduled bill payment fails due to insufficient balance, NovaPay automatically retries once after 24 hours. If it fails again, the user is notified in-app and must retry manually.

15. Statements & Account History

- Monthly account statements are available under Settings > Statements as downloadable PDFs, covering the most recent 24 months.
- For records older than 24 months, users can request an extended statement through support; these are delivered within 5 business days.
- Full transaction history remains viewable in the app indefinitely, but CSV export is limited to 12 months of history per export request.

16. Multi-Currency Wallet (Tier 3 Only)

- Tier 3 accounts can hold balances in USD, EUR, and GBP simultaneously within the same wallet.
- Converting between held currencies costs a 0.4% conversion fee and executes instantly at the live market rate.
- Only the USD balance can be used for domestic ACH transfers and Bill Pay. EUR and GBP balances can only be used for international transfers or card spending in those currencies.

17. Accessibility

- The NovaPay app supports screen readers (VoiceOver on iOS, TalkBack on Android), adjustable text size, and a high-contrast display mode under Settings > Accessibility.

- A dedicated accessibility support queue is available via in-app chat by selecting the 'Accessibility' topic, prioritized for faster response.

18. Troubleshooting Common App Issues

- App won't load or keeps crashing: force-close the app, confirm it is updated to the latest version, and restart the device. If the issue continues, submit a report via Settings > Help > Report a Problem.
- Card declined at a merchant: confirm the card is not frozen under Card > Freeze Card, confirm sufficient balance, and check Settings > Card Controls, where categories such as gambling or cash-equivalent purchases may be restricted by default and can be toggled on if needed.
- Not receiving a one-time passcode (OTP): check phone signal, confirm the registered phone number is correct under Settings > Profile, and wait at least 60 seconds before requesting a resend. Contact support if an OTP still has not arrived after 3 attempts.

19. Supported Countries & Regional Availability

NovaPay accounts can currently be opened by residents of 12 supported countries: United States, Canada, United Kingdom, Ireland, Germany, France, Spain, the Netherlands, Australia, Singapore, India, and Mexico. The wallet's default currency is determined by the account holder's country of residence at signup.

Some features vary by country. For example, the NovaPay Credit Line is currently available only to residents of the United States, Canada, and the United Kingdom, and some international transfer corridors are not available to every supported country. The in-app Help Center shows the specific terms and available features for the user's country of residence.

20. Closing Your Account

- Accounts can be closed from Settings > Close Account.
- The wallet balance must be zero and there must be no pending disputes or outstanding credit line balance before closure can be requested.
- Closure processing takes up to 7 business days.
- Per regulatory requirements, transaction records are retained for 5 years even after account closure.
- A closed account cannot be reopened; the user must create a new account and complete KYC again.

21. Fraud Prevention & Reporting Unauthorized Activity

- If you notice an unauthorized transaction, freeze your card immediately from the app, then contact support within 60 days of the transaction.
- NovaPay applies a zero-liability policy for unauthorized card transactions reported within 2 business days of discovery. Transactions reported later (up to the 60-day window) are still investigated but may be subject to additional review.
- NovaPay will never ask for your password or one-time passcode (OTP) over the phone, by email, or by text message. Any such request is a phishing attempt and should be reported to support immediately.
- Suspicious account activity may trigger a temporary hold on the account for up to 5 business days while the security team reviews it.

22. Data Privacy & Security

- All data is encrypted in transit using TLS 1.3 and at rest using AES-256.
- User data is shared only with financial regulators, payment networks, and contracted service providers necessary to operate the service.
- Users can request a data export or deletion under Settings > Privacy, subject to the regulatory 5-year retention requirement for transaction records.

23. Contact & Escalation

- In-app chat support is available 24/7, with an average first response time of 3 minutes.
- Email support: support@novapay.example, with a response within 24 hours.
- Phone support is available from 8:00 AM to 10:00 PM local time, 7 days a week.
- If an issue remains unresolved after 5 business days, users can request escalation to the Grievance Redressal Officer via Support > Escalate My Issue.
- If a complaint remains unresolved after 30 days, users may approach the relevant financial services ombudsman in their jurisdiction.

24. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How long does it take to verify my identity?

A: Tier 1 is instant. Tier 2 usually completes within 15 minutes (max 24 hours). Tier 3 can take up to 3 business days.

Q: What is the fee for an international transfer?

A: A flat \$4.99 plus a 0.5% foreign exchange markup on the converted amount.

Q: Can I get my money back if I sent a P2P payment to the wrong person?

A: No. Completed P2P transfers cannot be reversed by NovaPay. Support can ask the recipient to voluntarily return the funds, but cannot guarantee or force a refund.

Q: How many free ATM withdrawals do I get?

A: 4 free withdrawals per calendar month; \$2.50 per withdrawal after that, plus any fee charged by the ATM operator.

Q: What happens if I miss a credit line payment?

A: A flat \$10 late fee is charged. Accounts more than 60 days overdue may be reported to a credit bureau.

Q: How do I report a lost card?

A: Freeze it instantly from the app under Card > Freeze Card, then contact support to request a replacement.

Q: Is there a fee to close my account?

A: No, closing an account is free, but your balance must be zero with no pending disputes or credit line balance first.

Q: How long do I have to dispute an unrecognized charge?

A: 60 days from the transaction date.

Q: How much interest do Savings Pockets earn?

A: 2.5% APY on balances up to \$10,000 per pocket, and 0.5% APY on any amount above \$10,000 in that pocket, paid monthly.

Q: Is there a fee to pay a new biller I haven't paid before?

A: Yes, a one-time payment to a new, unsaved payee costs \$0.50. Payments to saved payees are free.

Q: Can I hold more than one currency in my NovaPay wallet?

A: Only Tier 3 accounts can hold USD, EUR, and GBP simultaneously, with a 0.4% fee to convert between them.

Q: Which countries can open a NovaPay account?

A: United States, Canada, United Kingdom, Ireland, Germany, France, Spain, the Netherlands, Australia, Singapore, India, and Mexico.

Q: Is the NovaPay Credit Line available everywhere?

A: No, it is currently only available to residents of the United States, Canada, and the United Kingdom.

Q: How far back can I download my statements?

A: Statements are available as PDFs for the most recent 24 months. Older records can be requested from support and are delivered within 5 business days.

Note: this knowledge base intentionally does not cover certain topics — for example cryptocurrency trading, business/merchant accounts, joint accounts, investment products, insurance products, and tax reporting forms. These are out of scope by design, useful for testing whether a support system correctly says information is not available rather than guessing.